

MS WORD ESSENTIALS · CHAPTER SERIES

MS Word Essentials

Chapter 17 · Mail Merge Basics





Course Roadmap — 20 Chapters

MS Word Essentials · Guided practice every chapter, full assignment every 4

01	Getting Started with MS Word
02	Basic Text Entry & Editing
03	Character Formatting
04	Paragraph Formatting
05	Practice Assignment 1
06	Working with Lists
07	Page Setup & Layout
08	Headers, Footers & Page Numbers
09	Working with Tables
10	Practice Assignment 2

11	Inserting Images & Shapes
12	Styles & Themes
13	Using Templates
14	Spelling, Grammar & Proofing
15	Practice Assignment 3
16	Track Changes & Reviewing
17	Mail Merge Basics
18	Long Documents: TOC & Footnotes
19	Sharing, Exporting & Printing
20	Final Project: Build Your CV

▲ TODAY

[Recap](#) · [Chapter 16](#)

Recap: Chapter 16

1

Track Changes Records Every Edit

Insertions, deletions, and formatting changes all get marked.

2

Underline Means Added, Strikethrough Means Removed

The two markup styles tell different stories.

3

Accept or Reject Settles Each Change

One decision at a time, or all at once.

4

Comments Discuss Without Editing

Leave a note on the text without changing the words themselves.

Preview

Today's Objectives

1

Understand What Mail Merge Is

See how one letter can become many personalized copies.

2

Set Up a Data Source

Build a simple list of recipients and their details.

3

Insert Merge Fields

Drop recipient details into a letter as placeholders.

4

Complete the Merge

Turn the letter and the list into finished, personalized documents.

Theory · [What Mail Merge Is](#)

What Mail Merge Is

1

One Letter, Many Recipients

It creates personalized copies of one document, each filled in with different details.

2

Two Parts

A main document, the letter, and a data source, the recipient list, work together.

3

Common Uses

Certificates, invitations, and notices sent to a whole class or group.

4

Mailings Tab

Every mail merge tool lives on the Mailings tab in the ribbon.

Setting Up the Data Source

1

What a Data Source Is

It is a table of information. One row per person, one column per detail.

2

Using an Excel List

Mailings tab → Select Recipients → Use an Existing List. Pick a saved Excel file.

3

Typing a New List

Select Recipients → Type a New List. Build the list directly inside Word.

4

Column Headers Matter

Each column header becomes a merge field name. Keep them short and clear.

[Theory](#) · [Inserting Merge Fields](#)

Inserting Merge Fields

1

Insert Merge Field Button

Mailings tab → Insert Merge Field. Pick a column name to drop into the letter.

2

Fields Look Like Placeholders

A field appears inside double angle brackets, until you preview the merge.

3

Preview Results

Mailings tab → Preview Results. This swaps fields for real data, one recipient at a time.

4

Fixing a Field

Delete a field like any text. Then insert the correct one from the list.

[Theory](#) · [Completing the Merge](#)

Completing the Merge

1

Finish & Merge Button

Mailings tab → Finish & Merge. This is the last step once fields are in place.

2

Edit Individual Documents

Creates one long document, one page per recipient, ready to review or print.

3

Print Documents

Sends every merged copy straight to the printer, skipping the extra file.

4

Save Before You Merge

Always save the main document first, in case you need to reuse it later.

PRACTICE

Build a Recipient List

1

Start the Merge

Mailings tab → Start Mail Merge → Letters.

2

Type a New List

Select Recipients → Type a New List.

3

Add Two Entries

Enter two students: “Ali Raza” and “Sana Khan,” each with Class set to “Computer Basics.”

4

Save the List

Save the list as YourName_Recipients.

PRACTICE

Merge a Certificate Line

1

Type the Sentence

Type: “This certifies that ” then leave a space.

2

Insert the Name Field

Mailings tab → Insert Merge Field → First Name.

3

Preview the Results

Mailings tab → Preview Results. Check that both names appear correctly.

4

Finish the Merge

Finish & Merge → Edit Individual Documents. Confirm two pages are created.

Wrap-Up

Key Takeaways

1

Mail Merge Combines Two Parts

A main document and a data source work together.

2

Data Sources Are Just Tables

One row per person, one column per detail.

3

Fields Pull in Real Data

Preview Results swaps placeholders for actual information.

4

Finish & Merge Completes the Job

It creates one personalized copy per recipient.

Next up — Chapter 18: Long Documents: TOC & Footnotes